Lena Varga-Holm
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Dear Halden Pay Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer - Data Platform position. Your emphasis on reusable frameworks rather than one-off pipelines closely matches my work: owning production ingestion and orchestration, building shared Python tooling, and making data quality part of delivery. I bring nine years of data engineering experience, including transaction reconciliation and warehouse design in payments.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own an ingestion layer of approximately 140 Airflow DAGs and participate in the platform's on-call rotation. I migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into dbt, introduced incremental models and slim CI, and helped bring nightly build time from 5h10 to 1h35. Data contracts backed by JSON Schema and CI checks reduced broken-pipeline incidents from approximately nine to two per month. Alongside reliability, I addressed operating costs: warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables reduced the monthly Snowflake bill from approximately 38,000 to 24,000.

My payments experience would also be relevant to Halden Pay's cross-border business payments platform. At Kovalent Pay, I built PySpark reconciliation jobs on AWS EMR processing approximately 1.2 TB daily, reducing manual month-end reconciliation from approximately three days to four hours. I designed a dimensional Redshift warehouse for finance and risk and developed an S3 and Glue Data Catalog library used by four teams. My cloud experience is in AWS, supported by the AWS Certified Data Engineer - Associate certification awarded in May 2024; Airflow, dbt, Python, SQL, Docker and GitHub Actions provide substantial overlap with your engineering stack.

Your support for open-source contributions is particularly relevant to my two merged Airflow provider pull requests, which fixed a pagination bug and added tests. I also mentor two engineers and run weekly platform office hours, bringing practical experience of sharing knowledge and supporting platform users. I would welcome a conversation about how I could help Halden Pay build reusable platform capabilities and dependable data quality standards.

Kind regards,
Lena Varga-Holm